

Kudzaishe Zharare

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Experience

Poza 2025 - Present

Founder and Software Engineer

- Led discovery through 56 merchant and payments-stakeholder interviews; translated findings into product requirements, user journeys, interface prototypes, and technical architecture.
- Built Flutter/Dart mobile apps, web interfaces, and TypeScript services on AWS, connecting account creation, identity verification, and financial account workflows.
- Built document verification using PaddleOCR, passport and barcode validation, and facial matching; integrated AWS Rekognition liveness checks into onboarding.
- Implemented Airwallex payment and card integrations, a PostgreSQL wallet ledger with deposit matching and reconciliation, and Alpaca brokerage onboarding, funding, and orders in sandbox.

Cleva Technologies (YC W24) Apr 2024 - 2025

Lead Software Engineer

- Led KYC automation with Veriff and an in-house verification flow, replacing waits of 2 days to 3 weeks with decisions in under a minute for eligible completed submissions; built infrastructure used as Cleva scaled beyond 1 million users.
- Built Nigerian NIN verification using OCR and AWS Rekognition face comparison, plus face indexing and search to detect duplicate accounts; routed uncertain cases to reviewers with explicit reasons.
- Designed a configurable JSON Logic engine for approximately 100 evolving KYC rules, enabling policy updates and feature flags with deterministic approval, denial, and manual-review outcomes.

FlexID Technologies 2021 - 2023

CTO, later Co-Founder

- Led a distributed engineering team building identity wallets across Android, web, and WhatsApp, with Algorand and verifiable credentials; owned architecture, cloud infrastructure, APIs, and SDKs.

Motapa, trading as Mutapa 2019 - 2021

Founder and Systems Architect

- Led a five-person delivery team for CBZ's contracted 200-merchant programme, implementing iVeri payment integrations for universities, retailers, healthcare providers, and public institutions; coordinated merchant training and bank liaison.
- Extended support through 2022 across card and EcoCash payments; added 3D Secure, Cybersource Decision Manager, and Zimswitch gateway integrations in subsequent work. Built Mutapa Marketplace, later acquired by CBZ Holdings.

The World Bank 2019 - 2020

Country Lead Engineer, DRIVER Project

- Built Zimbabwe's crash-reporting application and national dashboards; led rollout with police, ambulance services, and the Ministry of Health.

Skills

Languages and frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Dart, Flutter, Node.js, React, Django

Cloud and data: AWS, CDK, Lambda, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Redis, Docker

Systems: LLM tool calling, Smithy, REST APIs, webhooks, idempotency, authorization, KYC, OCR

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2019

B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics